GCC ATLAS

Receipts for India’s GCC market

What a single source of truth should look like, who it serves first, and a prototype that already works on real sources.

Product Intern assignment · Gagan Mahajan · 13 October 2026

Open the prototype

THE PROBLEM

Everyone in the GCC chain knows something. A newcomer has to piece it together.

The basics are disputed

Reports give different counts of GCCs. Their dates and definitions are hard to compare.

The chain is long

Advisers, landlords, recruiters, payroll firms, lawyers, auditors and states. Each sees one slice.

So people ask around

With delivery evidence scattered, a new company falls back on referrals.

EVEN THE COUNT IS DISPUTED

How many GCCs does India have? It depends who you ask.

1,700+

Government of India, Press Information Bureau

1,800+

Dun & Bradstreet, GCC 2026 report

2,117

nasscom and Zinnov, FY2026. Or 3,728 if you count centres, not companies.

536

listed with sources in Flexiple's directory, Aug 2026

These are different snapshots. A useful record must show its date, scope and definition.

Sources: PIB; Dun & Bradstreet GCC 2026; Zinnov-nasscom GCC Landscape 2026; Flexiple, Aug 2026

THE PLAYERS

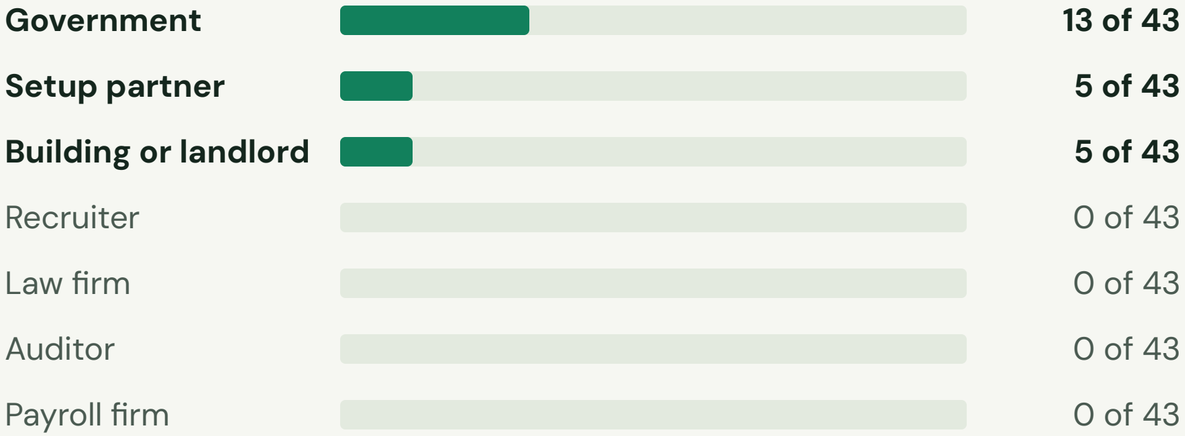
Seven players. Each sees one slice.

Player	What it holds	Why it does not share
Company entering India	A budget and a deadline	Buys once, so it cannot compare
Advisers and build-operate partners	Playbooks and past clients	Sells the answer it recommends
Landlords and brokers	Rents and lease terms	Paid when the deal closes
Recruiters, payroll and EOR firms	Pay data and hiring speed	Paid per hire or per head
Law and audit firms	Structure and compliance risk	Almost never named in public
State governments	Incentives, land, clearances	Competing with other states
Existing GCCs	What actually happened	No reason to publish it

The chain is the one listed in the assignment brief. The last column is my reading of each player’s incentive.

The public record shows almost none of the chain.

Who 43 announcements of new centres name



How I got this

I read the 42 sources behind Flexiple's own list of new centres and wrote down every outside party each one names.

AI did the reading. A program then matched every quoted sentence to its live page.

A source that names no recruiter does not prove none was used. It shows the record is silent.

43 announcements, 42 sources cited on Flexiple's new-GCC list. Checked 13 Oct 2026.

HOW MUCH

The decision is large. Its cost of failure is still unmeasured.

$41,700

reported annual revenue per employee: $98.4 billion / 2.36 million. My calculation.

4 to 6

months to a working India entity, by Flexiple's estimate. A planning reference, not a guarantee.

583

mid-market GCCs, more than one in four. A segment worth testing with.

Revenue shows the scale of the sector. It does not tell us a centre's setup cost or the loss from a bad choice.

Sources: Zinnov-nasscom India GCC Landscape 2026; flexiple.com/gcc/setup

WHAT THEY DO TODAY

Four ways to find out. No shared record.

A referral

Fast and free. One person’s experience, and often a favour.

An advisory study

Tailored advice. Cost and transparency vary by firm.

An industry report

Market context. Engagement-level detail varies.

A provider’s website

Service claims and case studies. Delivery needs checking.

The opportunity: put the source, the claim and the gaps in one place.

THE OPPORTUNITIES

Five layers of truth. Connect the evidence.

Layer	The question it answers	Where it stands
GCC registry	Who is here?	Flexiple lists 536 with sources
Coming next	Who is arriving?	Flexiple tracks 48 announcements
Talent and pay	Who can I hire, and for how much?	Flexiple’s talent graph, 97.9M profiles
Location	Which state, which building, what incentive?	City pages, policy PDFs and lease filings
Provider proof	Who actually delivered, and for whom?	Scattered case studies; uneven disclosure

Flexiple already covers companies, talent and locations. Provider proof is the gap we would investigate first.

Source: Flexiple’s GCC directory, statistics and salary method pages, read 13 Oct 2026

WHICH MATTERS MOST

Provider proof matters most, for three reasons.

1

It is the open question

No announcement names a recruiter, law firm, auditor or payroll firm. Only 5 of 43 name a setup partner.

2

It compounds

Each checked engagement improves every later search. Providers that deliver have a reason to bring their own proof.

3

Flexiple may help check the result

A talent graph that sees headcount by company and city could confirm that a 60-person team in Pune exists.

Signals and location data come out of the same pipeline.

THE SOLUTION

A record where every claim carries its receipt.

Step 1

A source

A press release, case study, lease filing or state policy.

Step 2

AI reads it

It proposes who did what, each with the sentence that says so.

Step 3

A program checks

The sentence must be on the page, word for word, or it is dropped.

Step 4

A person approves

Proposed review workflow; rerun checks as sources change.

Three strengths of proof: Named in a public source | Backed by data: headcount, filings, leases | Confirmed by the client

FOR WHOM FIRST

The first-time entrant, building its India shortlist.

A company planning 20 to 200 people in India. Its India lead has a budget, a deadline and no network there.

- 583 mid-market GCCs already exist: more than one in four.
- Flexiple's GCC page is written for it: 20 or more people over three years.
- It may have little India setup experience to draw on.

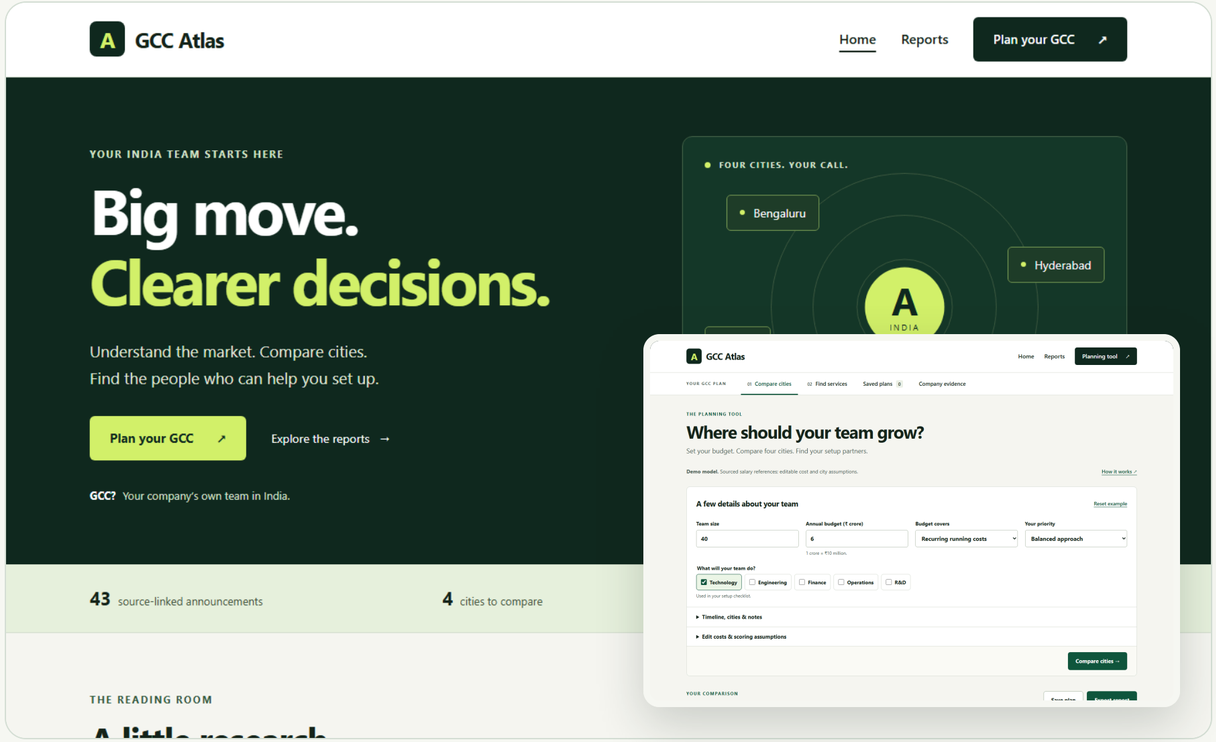
Its four questions

Question	Answered today by
Do companies like us do this?	The registry
Which city?	Talent and pay data
What will it cost?	A rough sum
Who do we trust to set it up?	A referral

Sources: Zinnov-nasscom India GCC Landscape 2026; flexiple.com/gcc

THE PROTOTYPE

It works today, on real sources.



Read. Compare. Shortlist.

- Reports grounded in 43 checked announcements
- Compare four cities with editable cost assumptions
- Explore legal, office, hiring and setup services
- Save a plan with providers and source links

City scores are demo assessments. A named relationship is not proof of good delivery.

Open the prototype

Working website + planning tool · browser-saved plans · linked sources

HOW AI IS USED

The AI step is checked, not trusted.

AI proposes

It reads the pasted text and returns the company, the city and anyone else named, each with one quoted sentence.

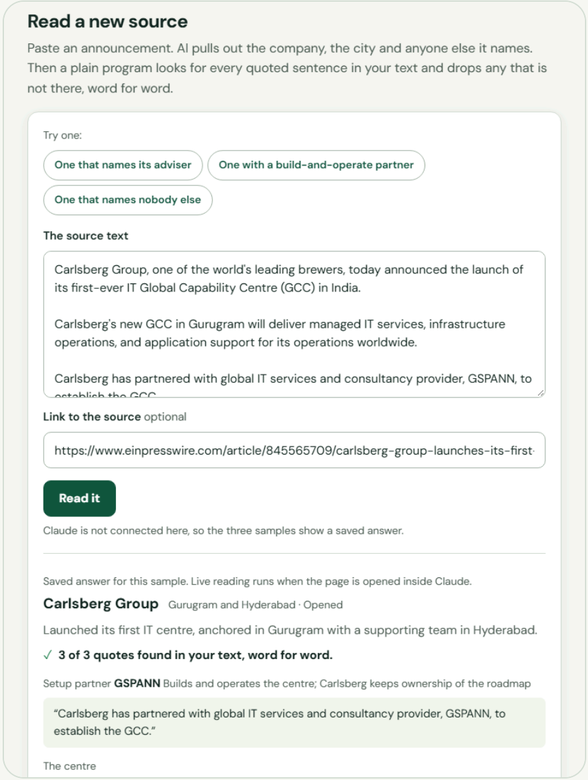
Code decides

Each quote is searched for in the text. One that is not there word for word is thrown away, with its claim.

Tested against invented quotes

In the tests a made-up sentence is dropped, and a made-up proof sentence rejects the whole answer.

This website replays three checked samples. Live reading requires the Claude integration and has not been verified with the real model.



POSITIONING

The receipt layer for India’s GCC market.

Instead of	Its limit	The record gives
A referral	One person’s experience	Recorded engagements with their source
An advisory study	Paid advice; method varies	Open reading and a visible method
An industry report	Totals without names	Names, dates and the sentence behind each
A provider’s website	Evidence varies across claims	What is claimed beside what is shown

Not a directory and not a review site. A record anyone can check.

WHY EACH SIDE COMES

A reason for each side to come.

Who	Uses today	Comes for
Entrants	Referrals, a consultant	A shortlist with proof, in minutes
Providers that deliver	Ads, events, logo walls	Proof that beats a bigger marketing budget
Existing GCCs	Company announcements and peer networks	Correcting their own record, seeing peers
State governments	Roadshows and policy PDFs	Their agreements shown beside what opened
Analysts and press	Each other’s numbers	A source they can cite

THE HARD PART

Flexiple is itself a provider. So the rules are public.

Rule 1

Order by evidence only. No paid placement.

Rule 2

Flexiple’s own work sits under the same rules, labelled as its own.

Rule 3

Show what could not be verified. Flexiple’s statistics page already does.

Rule 4

Anyone named can correct an entry by sending a source.

FIRST 90 DAYS

One measure: roles on record per centre.

0.5 of 7

roles per centre are on the public record today, in this sample of 43.

Days 1 to 30

Every centre Flexiple lists, plus leases, case studies and state agreements.

Days 31 to 60

Test provider submissions and client confirmation. Explore headcount checks with the data team.

Days 61 to 90

Entrant shortlists: who has built a centre like ours, in this city.

Test first, with ten calls: will providers give proof to a record run by a rival, and will clients confirm it?

23 named parties across 43 announcements, against 7 roles in the chain

TRY IT

Open the record. Check any line of it.

Open GCC Atlas →

Read the reports. Compare cities. Save a shortlist with its sources. Built with AI; assumptions stay visible.